

1. The fact that there are contingent things is contingent.
2. Every contingent fact has an explanation. (PSR)
3. The fact that there are contingent things has an explanation. (1,2)
4. The fact that there are contingent things can't be explained by any contingent thing.
5. The fact that there are contingent things is explained by some thing which is not contingent. (3,4)
6. The fact that there are contingent things is explained by some necessary thing. (5)
7. There is a necessary thing which explains the existence of contingent things. (6)
8. If there is a necessary thing which explains the existence of contingent things, then God exists.

C. God exists. (7,8)

THE COSMOLOGICAL ARGUMENT

If it is valid, then we can turn to the question of whether it is sound. And this boils down to the question of whether all of the four independent premises are true.



Leibniz's
argument



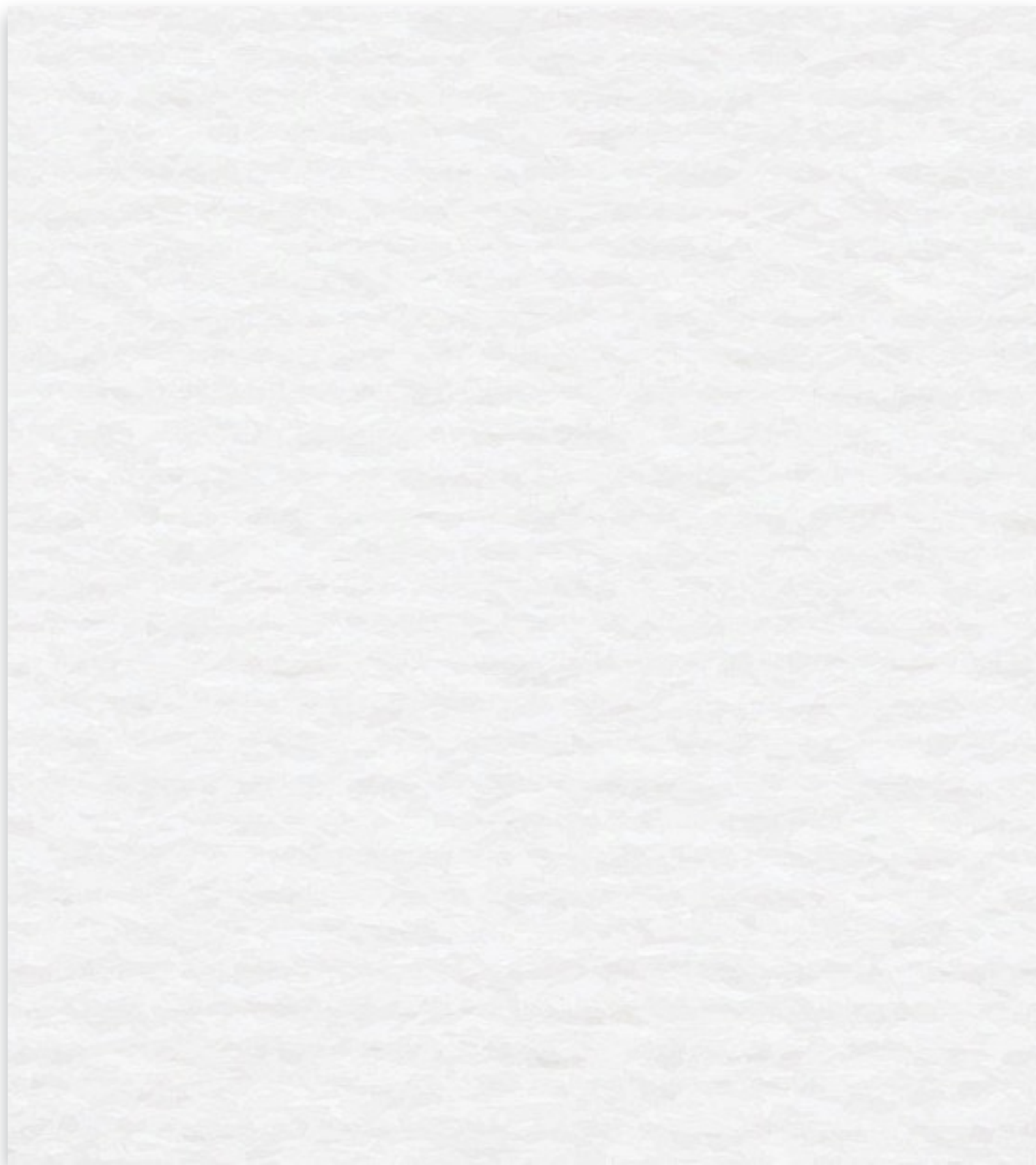
the
PSR



objections
to the
PSR

We've already discussed
premises (1), (4), and
(8).

If we grant that premises (1), (4), and (8) are true, and that the argument is valid, then the success of Leibniz's argument hinges on premise (2): the principle of sufficient reason. Let's turn to two objections to that premise.



1. The fact that there are not

things is coming.

4. The fact that there are not

expansion (PSR)

3. The fact that there are not

things has an explanation. (1,2)

continuing this.

2. Every event in the past has an

things can't be explained by any

which is not consistent. $(3, 4)$

5. The fact that there are

things is explained by some thing

things is explained by some

exp1a inst the exp inst enc of

explains the experience of

necessary thing. (5)

C. Godel exists. (7, 8)

continuing things. (6)

7. There is a necessary thing which

8. If there is a necessary thing which

6. The fact that there are countless

continuing things, then God exists.





the four independent

premises are true.

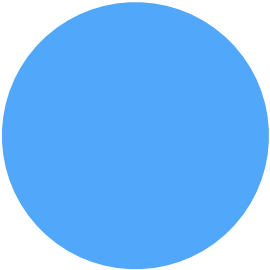
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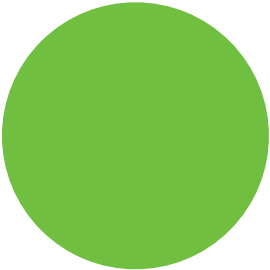
and that the argument is

(1) , (4) , and (8) are true,

on premise (2): the principle

that premise.





Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first

simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to

cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could

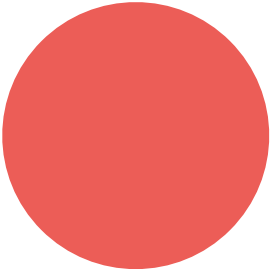
be Good.





objections
to the
PSR





... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.



Leibniz's
argument